Political Sociology.

Edmund Kelly.

Hilary Term 2026.

Welcome to Political Sociology. This course covers several important topics related to public opinion and political behaviour in different societies.

I will assign you one essay question each week. Please email your essay to me by 9am on the day of the tutorial. I will not be able to mark late essays.

Each week, please read the core readings and as much as you can from the further readings. Don't worry if you're not able to read everything, there will be time to consolidate the readings over the vacation. Concentrate on thinking carefully about the content you do have time to read, rather than rushing through the whole list.

There is also a more extensive departmental reading list available on Canvas, in which you can find additional readings for each topic.

Tutorials will be held on Tuesdays, from 4.30-5.30pm, in Room 132 in the Manor Road Building. Please meet me in the ground floor lobby a few minutes beforehand.

A collection will be held in Week 0 of Trinity Term. You will be asked to write 3 essays in 3 hours, from a choice of 12 questions. This replicates the structure of the final exam.

Any questions or concerns, please reach out to me at edmund.kelly@politics.ox.ac.uk.

Please make sure that your essays meet the below requirements.

1. Maximum 1600 words, excluding bibliography. Minimum 1200 words.
2. Sensible font and font size.
3. Double spaced.
4. Proper referencing in the text (in any sensible, consistent format).

Reading list key.

* indicates required reading.

Week 1. Political culture and social capital.

Essay questions.

1. Compare the effects of social capital and political culture on the quality of democracy.
2. Do successful democracies need a supportive political culture?
3. How important is trust for democracy?

Core reading

*Almond, Gabriel and Sidney Verba, (1963). The Civic Culture: Political Attitudes and Democracy in Five Nations. London: Sage. Chapters 1 and 13.

*Acemoglu, Daron, Nicolás Ajzenman, Cevat Giray Aksoy, Marfin Fiszbein, and Carlos Molina. 2024. "(Successful) Democracies Breed Their Own Support." Review of Economic Studies.

*Claassen, Christopher. 2019. "Does Public Support Help Democracy Survive?" American Journal of Political Science 150(1).

*Devine, Daniel. 2024. "Does Political Trust Matter? A Meta-analysis on the Consequences of Trust." Political Behavior 46(4).

*Muller, Edward and Mitchell Seligson (1994). Civic culture and democracy: the question of causal relationships. American Political Science Review, 88(3): 635-652.

*Paxton, Pamela (2002). Social Capital and Democracy: An Interdependent Relationship. American Sociological Review 67.

*Van der Meer, T.W. and Janssen, L.A., 2025. Pushing and Pulling: The Static and Dynamic Effects of Political Distrust on Support for Representative Democracy and its Rivals. Political Behavior, pp.1-23.

Further reading

Bartels, Larry M. 2022. "Democracy Erodes from the Top: Public Opinion and Democratic "Backsliding" in Europe." In Economou, Kyriazis, and Plafias (eds) Democracy in Times of Crises, Challenges, Problems and Policy Proposals. Spinger.

Berman, S. (1997). Civil society and the collapse of the Weimar Republic. World Politics, 49(3), 401 429.

Citrin, Jack and Laura Stoker. 2018. Political Trust in a Cynical Age. Annual Review of Political Science, v.21, n.1: 49–70.

Claassen, C., 2020. In the mood for democracy? Democratic support as thermostatic opinion. American Political Science Review, 114(1), pp.36-53.

Dahlum, Sirianne, and Carl Henrik Knutsen. 2017. “Democracy by Demand? Investigating the Effect of Self-Expression Values on Political Regime Type.” British Journal of Political Science 47(2): 437–61.

Dalton, Russell J. and Christian Welzel (eds.). 2014. The Civic Culture Transformed: From Allegiant to Assertive Citizens. New York: Cambridge University Press. Chapter 1.

Foa, Roberto Stefan, and Grezegorz Ekiert. 2016. “The Weakness of Postcommunist Civil Society Reassessed.” European Journal of Political Research.

Kelly, Edmund, James Tilley, and Sven Oskarsson., 2025. “Revisiting the link between political trust and political participation”. The Journal of Politics.

Norris, Pippa. 2011. Democratic Deficit: Critical Citizens Revisited. New York: Cambridge University Press.

Putnam, Robert (with R. Leonardi and R. Nanetti). 1993. Making Democracy Work: Civic Traditions in Modern Italy. Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press. Chapters. 1, 4, and 6.

Rovny, Jan. 2023. “Antidote to Backsliding: Ethnic Politics and Democratic Resilience.” American Political Science Review 117(4): 1410–28.

Stavnskær Doucette, Jonathan. 2024. “Pre-Modern Institutions and Later Support for Autocrats in Democratic Elections.” British Journal of Political Science.

Week 2. Class, education and economic inequalities.

Essay questions.

1. Is class politics a result of self-interest or socialisation?
2. Why has the pattern of class voting in Western countries changed in recent decades?
3. How do class, education, wealth and other economic inequalities affect voting behaviour?

Core reading

*Abou-Chadi, Tarik, and Simon Hix. 2021. 'Brahmin Left versus Merchant Right? Education, Class, Multiparty Competition, and Redistribution in Western Europe'. The British Journal of Sociology 72(1): 79–92.

*Evans, Geoffrey and James Tilley. 2012. The Depoliticization of Inequality and Redistribution: Explaining the Decline of Class Voting. The Journal of Politics, v.74, n.4: 963–976.

*Heath, Anthony, John Curtice and Gabriella Elgenius (2009) 'Individualisation and the Decline of Class Identity'. In Margaret Wetherell, ed. Identity in the 21st Century. Palgrave Macmillan. HM753.IDE 2009.

*Rueda, David. 2005. Insider–Outsider Politics in Industrialized Democracies: The Challenge to Social Democratic Parties. American Political Science Review, v.99, n.1 (February): 61-74.

Further reading

Ansell, Ben, Frederik Hjorth, Jacob Nyrup, and Marfin Vinæs Larsen. 2021. 'Sheltering Populists? House Prices and the Support for Populist Parties'. The Journal of Politics.

Ares, Macarena. 2020. 'Changing Classes, Changing Preferences: How Social Class Mobility Affects Economic Preferences'. West European Politics 43(6): 1211–37.

Carnes, Nicholas and Noam Lupu. 2015. Rethinking the Comparative Perspective on Class and Representation: Evidence from Latin America. American Journal of Political Science, v.59, n.1 (January): 1–18.

Carnes, Nicholas. 2012. Does the Numerical Underrepresentation of the Working Class in Congress Matter? Legislative Studies Quarterly 37(1): 5–34.

Elff, Martin. 2007. Social Structure and Electoral Behavior in Comparative Perspective: The Decline of Social Cleavages in Western Europe Revisited. Perspectives on Politics, v.5, n.2: 277–294.

Evans, G. and Tilley, J., 2017. The New Politics of Class: The Political Exclusion of the British Working Class. Oxford University Press.

Evans, Geoffrey, Rune Stubager, and Peter Egge Langsæther. 2022. 'The Conditional Politics of Class Identity: Class Origins, Identity and Political Attitudes in Comparative Perspective'. West European Politics 45(6): 1178–1205.

Gingrich, Jane. 2017. A New Progressive Coalition? The European Left in a Time of Change. The Political Quarterly, v.88, n.1 (January–March): 39-51

Grant, Zack, and Geoffrey Evans. 2024. "A New Dilemma of Social Democracy? The British Labour Party, the White Working Class and Ethnic Minority Representation." British Journal of Political Science 54(3): 793–815.

Heath, Oliver. 2013. "Policy Representation, Social Representation and Class Voting in Britain." British Journal of Political Science.

Jansen, Giedo, Geoffrey Evans, and Nan Dirk de Graaf. 2013. "Class voting and Left–Right party positions: A Comparative study of 15 Western democracies, 1960–2005." Social Science Research 42(2): 376–400.

Kitschelt, H, and P Rehm. 2014. "Occupation as a Site of Political Preference Formation." Comparative Political Studies 47(12): 1670–1706.

O'Grady, Tom. 2018. "Careerists Versus Coal-Miners: Welfare Reforms and the Substantive Representation of Social Groups in the British Labour Party." Comparative Political Studies

Oesch, Daniel, and Line Rennwald. 2018. "Electoral Competition in Europe's New Tripolar Political Space: Class Voting for the Left, Centre-Right and Radical Right." European Journal of Political Research 7(2): 271.

Robinson, Justin, Pavlos Vasilopoulos, and Sofia Vasilopoulou. 2025. "Does the Accumulation of Assets Shape Voting Preferences? Evidence from a Longitudinal Study in Britain." British Journal of Political Science 55.

Weakliem, David and Anthony Heath. 1994. Rational Choice and Class Voting. Rationality and Society, v.6, n.2: 243-270.

Week 3. Attitudes to minorities, and the populist right.

Essay questions.

1. Why are some people more hostile to immigrants than others?
2. What explains the varying success of populist right parties?

Core reading

*Claassen, Christopher, and Lauren McLaren. 2021. "Does Immigration Produce a Public Backlash or Public Acceptance? Time-Series, Cross-Sectional Evidence From Thirty European Democracies." British Journal of Political Science.

*Carella, L. and Ford, R., 2020. The status stratification of radical right support: Reconsidering the occupational profile of UKIP's electorate. Electoral Studies, 67, p.102214.

*Cavaille, Charlotte, and John Marshall. 2018. 'Education and Antiimmigration Attitudes: Evidence from Compulsory Schooling Reforms across Western Europe'. American Political Science Review.

*Golder, Matt (2003) Explaining variation in the success of extreme right parties in Western Europe. Comparative Political Studies.

*Meguid, Bonnie M. (2005). Competition between unequals: The role of mainstream party strategy in niche party success. American Political Science Review, 99(3): 347-359

Further reading

Bakker, B. N.; M. Rooduijn; and G. Schumacher. 2015. The Psychological Roots of Populist Voting: Evidence from the United States, the Netherlands, and Germany. European Journal of Political Research.

Bolet, Diane, and Florian Foos. 2025. "Media Platforming and the Normalisation of Extreme Right Views." British Journal of Political Science 55

Helms, Benjamin. 2023. 'Global Economic Integration and Nativist Politics in Emerging Economies'. American Journal of Political Science.

Hiers, Wesley, Thomas Soehl, and Andreas Wimmer. 2017. "National Trauma and the Fear of Foreigners: How Past Geopolitical Threat Heightens Antiimmigration Sentiment Today." Social Forces 96(1): 361–88.

Hjorth, Frederik, and Martin Vinæs Larsen. 2022. "When Does Accommodation Work? Electoral Effects of Mainstream Left Position Taking on Immigration." British Journal of Political Science.

Ivarsflaten, E. 2007. "What Unites Right-Wing Populists in Western Europe?: Re-Examining Grievance Mobilization Models in Seven Successful Cases." Comparative Political Studies 41(1): 3–23.

Jeannet, Anne-Marie. 2018. “Revisiting the Labor Market Competition Hypothesis in a Comparative Perspective: Does Retirement Affect Opinion About Immigration?” Research and Politics

Laaker, Dillon. 2024. “Economic Shocks and the Development of Immigration Attitudes.” British Journal of Political Science 54(1): 220–40.

Lucassen, G. and Lubbers, M., 2012. Who fears what? Explaining far-right-wing preference in Europe by distinguishing perceived cultural and economic ethnic threats. Comparative Political Studies, 45(5), pp.547 574.

Magni, Gabriele. 2020. “Economic Inequality, Immigrants and Selective Solidarity: From Perceived Lack of Opportunity to in-Group Favouritism.” British Journal of Political Science 26.

Maxwell, Rahsaan. 2019. “Cosmopolitan Immigration Attitudes in Large European Cities: Contextual or Compositional Effects?” American Political Science Review 113(2): 456–74.

Pardos Prado, Sergi. 2015. “How Can Mainstream Parties Prevent Niche Party Success? Center-Right Parties and the Immigration Issue”. The Journal of Politics, v.77, n.2: 352–67.

Schäfer, Armin. 2022 “Cultural Backlash? How (Not) to Explain the Rise of Authoritarian Populism.” British Journal of Political Science.

Scheiring, G., Serrano-Alarcón, M., Moise, A., McNamara, C., & Stuckler, D. (2024). The populist backlash against globalization: A meta-analysis of the causal evidence. British Journal of Political Science.

Schwartz, Cassilde, Miranda Simon, David Hudson, and Jennifer van Heerde-Hudson. 2020. “A Populist Paradox? How Brexit Softened Anti-Immigrant Attitudes.” British Journal of Political Science.

Week 4. Gender.

Essay questions.

1. Why do some countries have more women legislators and leaders than others?
2. Why do gender gaps in political attitudes and voting change over time?

Core reading

*Clayton, Amanda. 2021. "How Do Electoral Gender Quotas Affect Policy?" Annual Review of Political Science 24(1): 235–52.

*Paxton, Pamela and Kunoichi, Sheri (2003). Women's Political representation: The importance of ideology. Social Forces, 82(1): 87-113.

*Robinson, Amanda Lea, and Jessica Gottlieb. 2019. "How to Close the Gender Gap in Political Participation: Lessons From Matrilineal Societies in Africa." British Journal of Political Science 62.

*Neundorf, Anja, and Rosalind Shorrocks. 2021. 'Revisiting the Impact of Modernization on Support for Women Politicians: The Role of Women's Political Empowerment:' Comparative Political Studies.

*Weeks, Ana Catalano, Bonnie M Meguid, Miki Caul Kiftilson, and Hilde Coffé. 2022 'When Do Männerparteien Elect Women? Radical Right Populist Parties and Strategic Descriptive Representation.' American Political Science Review:

Further reading

Astudillo, Javier, and Andreu Paneque. 2021. "Do Party Primaries Punish Women? Revisiting the Trade-Off Between the Inclusion of Party Members and the Selection of Women as Party Leaders." Party Politics 4(2).

Bernhard, R., Shames, S. and Teele, D.L., 2021. To emerge? Breadwinning, motherhood, and women's decisions to run for office. American Political Science Review, 115(2), pp.379-394.

Betz, Timm, David Fortunato, and Diana Z. O'Brien. 2023. "Do Women Make More Protectionist Trade Policy?" American Political Science Review 117(4): 1522–30.

Gillion, D., Ladd, J., & Meredith, M. 2020. "Party Polarization, Ideological Sorting and the Emergence of the US Partisan Gender Gap", British Journal of Political Science.

Chattopadhyay, Raghabendra, and Esther Duflo. 2004. "Women as Policy Makers: Evidence From a Randomized Policy Experiment in India." Econometrica 72(5): 1409–43.

Edlund, Lena, Rohini Pande, 2002. Why Have Women Become Left-Wing? The Political Gender Gap and the Decline in Marriage, The Quarterly Journal of Economics.

Fox, Richard L., and Jennifer L. Lawless. 2024. “The Invincible Gender Gap in Political Ambition.” PS: Political Science & Politics 57(2): 231–37.

Geus, Roosmarijn de, Elizabeth Ralph-Morrow, and Rosalind Shorrocks. 2022 ‘Understanding Ambivalent Sexism and Its Relationship with Electoral Choice in Britain’. British Journal of Political Science:

Gillion, Daniel Q, Jonathan M Ladd, and Marc Meredith. 2018. “Party Polarization, Ideological Sorting and the Emergence of the US Partisan Gender Gap.” British Journal of Political Science 51.

Gruneau, Moa Frödin, and Johanna Rickne. 2024. “Working Mothers and Political Daughters: Intergenerational Dynamics of Women’s Political Officeholding.” British Journal of Political Science:

Harteveld, E., & Ivarsflaten, E. (2018). Why Women Avoid the Radical Right: Internalized Norms and Party Reputation. British Journal of Political Science, 48(2), 369-384.

Landro, Gonzalo Di. 2025. “Party Behaviour and the Gender Voting Gap.” British Journal of Political Science 55.

Nyrup, Jacob, Hikaru Yamagishi, and Stuart Bramwell. 2023. ‘Consolidating Progress: The Selection of Female Ministers in Autocracies and Democracies’. American Political Science Review.

Oshri, Odelia, Liran Harsgor, Reut Itzkovitch-Malka, and Or Tuttnauer. 2022. ‘Risk Aversion and the Gender Gap in the Vote for Populist Radical Right Parties’. American Journal of Political Science.

Teele, Dawn Langan. 2023. ‘Gender and the Influence of Proportional Representation: A Comment on the Peripheral Voting Thesis’. American Political Science Review 117(2): 759–66.

Week 5. Social attitudes and value change.

Essay questions.

1. Why have people in high-income countries become more liberal?
2. What explains variation in concern for the environment and climate change?
3. How does education affect social attitudes and values?

Core reading

*Hooghe, Liesbet, Gary Marks, and Jonne Kamphorst. 2024. "Field of Education and Political Behavior: Predicting GAL/TAN Voting." American Political Science Review.

Inglehart, Ronald F. 2008. Changing Values among Western Publics from 1970 to 2006. West European Politics, v.*31, n.1-2: 130–146.

*Stubager, Rune (2008), 'Education effects on authoritarian-libertarian values: A question of socialisation', British Journal of Sociology 59 (2): 327-350.

*Surridge, P., 2016. Education and Liberalism: Pursuing the Link. Oxford Review of Education, 42(2), pp.146-164.

*Tilley, James (2005). Libertarian-authoritarian value change in Britain, 1974-2001. Political Studies 53(2): 442-453.

Further reading – climate change

Arndt, Christoph, Daphne Halikiopoulou, and Christos Vrakopoulos. 2023. "The Centre-Periphery Divide and Attitudes towards Climate Change Measures among Western Europeans." Environmental Politics 32(3): 381–406.

Böhmelt, Tobias, and Muzhou Zhang. 2024. "Supporting Environmental Protection in Good and Bad Economic Circumstances." Environmental Politics 33(2): 302–20.

Brehm, Johannes, and Henri Gruhl. 2024. "Increase in Concerns about Climate Change Following Climate Strikes and Civil Disobedience in Germany." Nature Communications 15(1): 2916.

Bush, Sarah Sunn, and Amanda Clayton. 2023. 'Facing Change: Gender and Climate Change Attitudes Worldwide'. American Political Science Review 117(2): 591–608.

Chaisty, Paul and Stephen Whitefield. 2015. Attitudes Towards the Environment: Are Post-Communist Societies (Still) Different? Environmental Politics, v.24, n.4: 598–616.

Egan, Patrick J, and Megan Mullin. 2023. 'US Partisan Polarization on Climate Change: Can Stalemate Give Way to Opportunity?' PS: Political Science & Politics.

Further reading – social attitudes

Andersen, R. and T. Fetner. 2008. Cohort Differences in Tolerance of Homosexuality: Attitudinal Change in Canada and the United States, 1981–2000. Public Opinion Quarterly, v.72, n.2: 311-330.

Brooks, Clem and Jeff Manza. 1994. Do Changing Values Explain the New Politics? A Critical Assessment of the Postmaterialist Thesis. Sociological Quarterly, v. 35, n.4: 541.

Clery, Elizabeth, and David Mead. 2017. "Civil Liberties: the Law, Individual Rights and the Government's Role in National Security." British Social Attitudes.

Clements, B, and C D Field. 2014. Public Opinion toward Homosexuality and Gay Rights in Great Britain. Public Opinion Quarterly*, v.*78, n.2: 523–547.

De Graaf, N.D. and Evans, G. (1996). Why are the young more postmaterialist? Comparative Political Studies 28(4): 608-635.

Fasching, Neil, and Yphtach Lelkes. 2024. "Ancestral Kinship and the Origins of Ideology." British Journal of Political Science 54(1):

Kalmijn, M. and G. Kraaykamp. 2007. Social Stratification and Attitudes: A Comparative Analysis of the Effects of Class and Education in Europe. The British Journal of Sociology, v.58, n.4: 547-576.

Perrett, Stuart. 2021. "A Divided Kingdom? Variation in Polarization, Surfing, and Dimensional Alignment Among the British Public, 1986–2018." The British Journal of Sociology 72(4): 992–1014.

Swales, Kirby, and Eleanor Aftar Taylor. 2017. "Moral Issues: Sex, Gender Identity and Euthanasia." British Social Attitudes.

Week 6. Attitudes to welfare.

Essay questions.

1. Why are some people more supportive of redistribution and welfare spending than others?
2. Do welfare states depend on a sense of social solidarity between rich and poor and between ethnic minorities and majorities?

Core reading

*Barth, Erling; Henning Finseraas; and Karl O Moene. 2014. Political Reinforcement: How Rising Inequality Curbs Manifested Welfare Generosity. *American Journal of Political Science, v.*59, n.3: 565–77.

*Dimick, Matthew; David Rueda; and Daniel Stegmueller. 2015 The Altruistic Rich? Inequality and Other-Regarding Preferences for Redistribution. Quarterly Journal of Political Science.

*Esping-Andersen, Gøsta. 1990. *The Three Worlds of Welfare Capitalism.* Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press. Chapter 1.

*O'Grady, Tom. 2017. "How Do Economic Circumstances Determine Preferences? Evidence From Long Run Panel Data." British Journal of Political Science.

*Rehm, Philipp, Jacob S Hacker, and Mark Schlesinger. 2012. "Insecure Alliances: Risk, Inequality, and Support for the Welfare State." American Political Science Review 106(02): 386–406.

*Rothstein, B., 2008. Is the Universal Welfare State a Cause or an Effect of Social Capital?. In G. T. Svendsen and G. L. H. Svendsen, eds. *Handbook of Social Capital: The Troika of Sociology, Political Science and Economics.* Cheltenham: Edward Elgar.

Rueda, David and Daniel Stegmueller. 2016. The Externalities of Inequality: Fear of Crime and Preferences for Redistribution in Western Europe. American Journal of Political Science, v.*60, n.2: 472–89.

Further reading

Alesina, Alberto and Edward Ludwig Glaeser (2004). Fighting Poverty in the US and Europe: A World of Difference. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Baldwin, Kate, and John D Huber. 2010. "Economic versus Cultural Differences: Forms of Ethnic Diversity and Public Goods Provision." American Political Science Review 104(04): 644–662.

Beramendi, Pablo, and Philipp Rehm. 2016. "Who Gives, Who Gains? Progressivity and Preferences." Comparative Political Studies 49(4): 529–63.

Findor, Andrej et al. 2023. 'Equality, Reciprocity, or Need? Bolstering Welfare Policy Support for Marginalized Groups with Distributive Fairness'. American Political Science Review 117(3): 805–21.

Fong, C. M. and E.F.P Luttmer. 2011. Do Fairness and Race Matter in Generosity? Evidence from a Nationally Representative Charity Experiment. Journal of Public Economics, 95(5-6): 372-394.

Gingrich, J, and B Ansell. 2012. "Preferences in Context: Micro Preferences, Macro Contexts, and the Demand for Social Policy." Comparative Political Studies 45(12): 1624–1654.

Lindqvist, Erik, and Robert Östling. 2010. "Political Polarization and the Size of Government." American Political Science Review 104(03): 543–565.

Lupu, Noam, and Jonas Pontusson. 2011. "The Structure of Inequality and the Politics of Redistribution." American Political Science Review 105(02): 316–336.

Moene, K. O. & Wallerstein, M., 2001. Inequality, Social Insurance, and Redistribution. *The* American Political Science Review, 95(4), pp. 859-874.

O'Grady, Tom, and Andreas Wiedemann. 2024. "How the Geographic Clustering of Young and Highly Educated Voters Undermines Redistributive Politics." The Journal of Politics 86(3): 934–52.

Peyton, K., 2020. Does trust in government increase support for redistribution? Evidence from randomized survey experiments. American Political Science Review, 114(2), pp.596-602.

Scheve, Kenneth, and Theo Serlin. 2023. 'The German Trade Shock and the Rise of the Neo-Welfare State in Early Twentieth-Century Britain'. American Political Science Review 117(2): 557–74.

Scheve, Kenneth, and David Stasavage. 2010. "The Conscription of Wealth: Mass Warfare and the Demand for Progressive Taxation." International Organization 64(4): 529–61.

Week 7. Media.

Essay questions.

1. Can the media influence election outcomes?
2. Have changes in the media and social media caused a rise of political polarization?
3. Does the mass media cause misperception of and disengagement from politics?

Core reading

*Flynn, D J, Brendan Nyhan, and Jason Reifler. 2017. "The Nature and Origins of Misperceptions: Understanding False and Unsupported Beliefs About Politics." Political Psychology 38(2): 127–50.

*Ladd, J.M.D., and G.S. Lenz. 2009. "Exploiting a rare communication shift to document the persuasive power of the news media." American Journal of Political Science 53(2): 394–410.

*Lenz, Gabriel S. 2009. "Learning and Opinion Change, Not Priming: Reconsidering the Priming Hypothesis." American Journal of Political Science 53(4): 821–837.

*Mutz, Diana C., and Byron Reeves. 2005. "The New Video malaise: Effects of Televised Incivility on Political Trust." The American Political Science Review 99(1): 1–15.

*Soroka, Stuart et al. 2012. "Auntie Knows Best? Public Broadcasters and Current Affairs Knowledge." British Journal of Political Science 43(04): 719–739.

*Zaller, John (1992). The Nature and Origins of Mass Opinion. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Further reading

Barnes, Lucy, and Timothy Hicks. 2018. "Making Austerity Popular: the Media and Mass Attitudes Toward Fiscal Policy." American Journal of Political Science 62(2): 340–54

Chauchard, Simon, and Sumitra Badrinathan. 2025. "The Religious Roots of Belief in Misinformation: Experimental Evidence from India." British Journal of Political Science 55

Druckman, James N, Matthew S Levendusky, and Audrey McLain. 2017. "No Need to Watch: How the Effects of Partisan Media Can Spread via Interpersonal Discussions." American Journal of Political Science 62(1): 99–112.

Foos, Florian, and Daniel Bischof. 2021. "Tabloid Media Campaigns and Public Opinion: Quasi Experimental Evidence on Euroscepticism in England." American Political Science Review.

Guess, Andrew M. 2021. "(Almost) Everything in Moderation: New Evidence on Americans' Online Media Diets." American Journal of Political Science.

Hopkins, Daniel J., Yphtach Lelkes, and Samuel Wolken. 2025. “The rise of and demand for identity oriented media coverage.” American Journal of Political Science 69(2): 483–500.

Kellstedt. Paul (2000). Media framing and the dynamics of racial policy preferences. American Journal of Political Science.

Lenz, Gabriel S, and Chappell Lawson. 2007. “Looking the part: Television leads less informed citizens to vote based on candidates' appearance.” American Journal of Political Science 55(3): 574–589.

Levendusky, Matthew S. 2013. “Why Do Partisan Media Polarize Viewers?” American Journal of Political Science 57(3): 611–23.

Sevenans, Julie. 2018. “How Mass Media Attract Political Elites’ Attention.” European Journal of Political Research 57(1): 153–70.

Wlezien, Chris. 2023. “News and Public Opinion: Which comes first?”, The Journal of Politics.

Wlezien, Christopher, and Stuart Soroka. 2023. ‘Media Reflect! Policy, the Public, and the News’. American Political Science Review.